

Chapter 121-4

Zhao Ying had wanted to finish filming this drama smoothly and steadily. After Shu Yi's initial incident, Zhao Ying's condition had begun to decline rapidly.

She was already quite good at enduring.

But after last night's episode, she felt that if she kept enduring any longer, by the time the drama finished filming, she would need to check herself into a psychiatric hospital first.

There was no one on set she could talk to, so she held it in all morning before finally giving in and coming to find Liang Shi.

Liang Shi listened quietly until she finished, guessed that she hadn't eaten, and handed her a small bread roll.

Zhao Ying was surprised, "How do you have everything here?"

Liang Shi: "....."

"I'm used to it," Liang Shi said. "I often get hungry in the middle of the night when filming."

Zhao Ying felt like she was a treasure chest, equipped with everything one could need.

"You don't seem like this is your first time on set at all." Zhao Ying tore off a piece of the bread and ate it. "Your small suitcase has everything."

Hearing this, Liang Shi shrugged and deliberately tried to lighten the mood, "Maybe I've been on set in my dreams."

Zhao Ying immediately stopped her, "Hold it! I'm scared of the word 'dream' now."

Liang Shi: "....."

What Zhao Ying needed was just someone to talk to, and Liang Shi played that role well.

After eating a small bread roll in Liang Shi's room and drinking a bottle of sports drink, Zhao Ying finally felt her condition improving somewhat.

After some thought, she asked Liang Shi again, "Do you think I should endure or leave?"

Liang Shi hesitated, "Which one are you more inclined toward?"

Like kicking a ball back, she tossed the question right back.

Her answer was watertight.

It wasn't really Liang Shi's fault.

She didn't have any true friends in the industry before—they were basically all casual acquaintances. As for how close they were, it really wasn't that close.

But when she had new dramas airing, there were quite a few people who helped promote them.

Every time she was on a set, she got along well with people. She could basically make two or three friends per drama, but that was limited to while on set and during promotions.

Normally, she kept a low profile.¹

Moreover, Sister Wang had warned her that there were no true friends in this industry.

Everyone was basically in it for mutual benefit, including Sister Wang.

People came together because their interests aligned. When it came to competing for resources, betrayal and drama were unavoidable.

So Liang Shi had developed the habit of speaking carefully and leaving no openings.

After answering Zhao Ying, she felt it was somewhat inadequate, so she added, "If you really feel like you can't hold on, then take a break first. Go on vacation, and when your condition improves, come back to film your parts in a concentrated period."

"The main thing is that looking at Shu Yi now gives me the creeps." Zhao Ying said, "I simply can't act with her. When I think of the look in her eyes last night, I want to cry."

Zhao Ying let out a light breath and couldn't help saying, "I keep thinking, what idiot would fall in love with that kind of psycho?! It's completely masochistic, okay?"

Liang Shi: "....."

From Zhao Ying's words, she could feel deep despair.

Liang Shi comforted her with a few words. Because she still had scenes to film—night scenes at that—she went to the crew first to get her makeup and hair done, leaving Zhao Ying alone to rest in the hotel.

Zhao Ying didn't want to go back to her own room, afraid of encountering Shu Yi having another episode, so Liang Shi let her stay in her room.

That night, Zhao Ying switched rooms and slept next door to Yan Xi.

And so, that night, it was said that the people staying on Shu Yi's floor heard knocking sounds for half the night.

A producer came out to check and was so frightened they lost bladder control.

Shu Yi was wearing a white spaghetti-strap nightgown, with a wig she had gotten from who knows where hanging straight down, knocking on Zhao Ying's door.

Like a female ghost straight out of a horror movie.

Everyone on that floor who came out saw that scene, including the director.

When Zhao Ying heard from the director the next day, she secretly celebrated that she had listened to Liang Shi's advice and changed her sleeping location. Otherwise, based on the producer's description, she might not have just lost bladder control—she might have had a heart attack and been sent straight to the hospital.

With her vivid imagination, just hearing about it made her scalp tingle, as if she had experienced it herself.

Zhao Ying still brought it up with the director, saying she couldn't continue working with Shu Yi.

Although she had said in school that she could sacrifice herself for art, she didn't want it to be this kind of death.

If word got out, people would laugh their teeth off.

The director hadn't seen Shu Yi like that before and had thought everyone was being alarmist. But this time he had seen it with his own eyes, and the level of horror was enough to frighten even him—someone who had previously directed horror films.

No wonder Zhao Ying had been out of sorts for so long.

The director nodded wearily, "I'll consider it."

Zhao Ying: "....."

Seeing that he was still hesitating, Zhao Ying said bluntly, "There's no way I'm acting with her anymore. Looking at her face feels like watching a horror movie. How am I supposed to act like I'm in love with her? Maybe in the next life."

The director: "If..."

"There are no ifs." Zhao Ying was always straightforward—once she made a decision, she didn't hesitate. "I've already endured several times. If I could still hold on, I wouldn't have brought this up with you. You've seen what Shu Yi is like, and you know what I was like when I filmed before. If it really doesn't work out, let's terminate the contract. I'll pay you the penalty fee, and we'll work together on the next drama."

The director: "....."

This directly backed the director into a corner with no way out.

He also knew that Zhao Ying was truly desperate.

After what happened that night, daytime filming naturally came to a halt.

Footnotes:

¹ **Kept a low profile (神隱狀態):** The term "神隱" (shen yin) literally means "hidden by the gods" and refers to someone who disappears from public view or maintains an extremely low profile. It's often used to describe celebrities who stay out of the spotlight when not working.